

the company's prospects improving, your overall return might have been twice again as high.

To make this spectacular showing, you only had to find one big winner out of eleven. The more right you are about any one stock, the more wrong you can be on all the others and still triumph as an investor.

APPLES AND DONUTS

You may have thought that a tenbagger can only happen with some wild penny stock in some weird company like Braino Biofeedback or Cosmic R and D, the kind of stock that sensible investors avoid. Actually there are numerous tenbaggers in companies you'll recognize: Dunkin' Donuts, Wal-Mart, Toys "R" Us, Stop & Shop, and Subaru, to mention a few. These are companies whose products you've admired and enjoyed, but who would have suspected that if you'd bought the Subaru stock along with the Subaru car, you'd be a millionaire today?

Yet it's true. This serendipitous calculation is based on several assumptions: first, that you bought the stock at its low of \$2 a share in 1977; second, that you sold at the high in 1986, which would have amounted to \$312 a share, unadjusted for an 8-for-1 split.* That's a 156-bagger, and the fiscal equivalent of 39 home runs, so if you'd invested \$6,410 in the stock (certainly in the price range of a car), you'd come out with \$1 million exactly. Instead of owning a battered trade-in, you'd now have enough money to be able to afford a mansion and a couple of Jaguars in the garage.